MARY B. AUSTIN PTA · DUTY-FREE LUNCH · VOLUNTEER TRAINING

Lunch Time Hero Playbook.

A few times a year, we give our teachers a **duty-free lunch**. It is a wonderful way to give them a break and to spend some time with the students in the class. To make it a success, here is what we ask of every volunteer, start to finish.

GOOD TO KNOW

You are never moving students through the building on your own. The **teacher walks you and the class to the cafeteria** at the start, and **comes back to the cafeteria to pick them up** at the end.

BEFORE THE BELL

- [ ] Arrive before the scheduled lunch time and sign in with the front office. The teacher will walk you and the class to the cafeteria together.

THROUGH THE LINE

- [ ] Students with lunch boxes head to the class-assigned tables. Stand and help the flow of your class through the lunch line, making sure everyone gets what they need (drink, utensils, and so on).

DURING LUNCH

- [ ] Sit with the class for the entire lunch period.
- [ ] Keep the first part of lunch about eating. Gently remind students to focus on their food and keep their area clean. Remind them to stay seated and use inside voices.
- [ ] If a child needs another utensil or the restroom, use your judgment. Try not to let multiple students go to the restroom at the same time.
- [ ] Walk between the tables to make sure students are following directions, keeping their area clean, and eating their lunch.

WRAPPING UP

- [ ] Walk the class to dispose of all trash. Ask them to clean their area as best they can and line up at the wall directly outside the cafeteria. (Lunch helpers stay in the cafeteria to wipe down tables and sweep.)
- [ ] Walk the class to the restroom and let students enter a few at a time. When they finish, have them line up to wait for the rest, and gently remind them not to play in the bathroom.
- [ ] When everyone is done, line the class back up and wait with them for their teacher to come pick them up at the cafeteria. Encourage them, and remind them what a good job they did!

THE HEART OF IT

You are the calm, friendly grown-up in the room. A little structure and a lot of encouragement is all it takes. **Thank you for showing up for our students and teachers!**